

Landlord Compliance Checklist — Victoria

The safety and minimum standards obligations every rental provider must meet.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice. Non-compliance can result in significant penalties and VCAT-ordered compensation — confirm current requirements with Consumer Affairs Victoria before relying on this checklist alone.

Section 1 — The 15 Mandatory Minimum Standards

Since 25 November 2025, all rental properties must meet these standards **before being advertised**, and must continue meeting them throughout the tenancy:

- ☐ ☐ **Bathrooms** — hot and cold running water, functioning toilet.
- ☐ ☐ **Electrical safety** — safe wiring and fittings.
- ☐ ☐ **Heating** — a fixed heater in the main living area (portable heaters generally don't satisfy this).
- ☐ ☐ **Kitchens** — a working stovetop with at least two burners and adequate food preparation space.
- ☐ ☐ **Laundries** — where provided, in working order.
- ☐ ☐ **Lighting** — adequate lighting in every room.
- ☐ ☐ **Locks** — functioning deadlocks on external entry doors.
- ☐ ☐ **Mould and damp** — free from mould/dampness caused by or related to the building structure.
- ☐ ☐ **Structural soundness** — including weatherproofing.
- ☐ ☐ **Toilets** — functioning.
- ☐ ☐ **Ventilation** — functioning ventilation in bathrooms and kitchens.
- ☐ ☐ **Vermin-proof bins**.
- ☐ ☐ **Windows** — functional and in reasonable condition.
- ☐ ☐ **Window coverings** — curtains or blinds in bedrooms and living areas.
- ☐ ☐ **Window covering cord anchors** — mandatory since 1 December 2025 for corded internal blinds/curtains, to prevent loop-related hazards.

Note: minimum standards generally apply to tenancy agreements starting on or after 29 March 2021, or older agreements that became periodic on or after that date — don't assume an older property or older lease is automatically exempt.

Section 2 — The "Big Three" Safety Checks

- ☐ ☐ **Smoke alarms** — must be properly installed, meet the relevant Australian Standard, and undergo **mandatory annual safety checks** (in effect since 25 November 2025). Keep dated records.
- ☐ ☐ **Gas safety checks** — required **every two years** by a licensed professional.
- ☐ ☐ **Electrical safety checks** — also required **every two years** by a licensed professional.
- ☐ ☐ **Provide the date of the most recent safety checks to renters before they sign a new lease** — this is a specific disclosure obligation, not just a maintenance best practice.
- ☐ ☐ **Keep all safety check records** — failure to do so can affect insurance validity in addition to attracting regulatory penalties.

Section 3 — Advertising and Application Obligations

- ☐ ☐ **Confirm the property meets all minimum standards before advertising it** — properties failing to meet these standards cannot legally be advertised or let.
- ☐ ☐ **Use the prescribed rental application form** (mandatory from 31 March 2026) and only request information set out in that form.
- ☐ ☐ **Never invite, encourage, or accept rent offers above the advertised price** — rental bidding has been banned since 25 November 2025.
- ☐ ☐ **Delete unsuccessful applicants' personal information within the required timeframe** — confirm the current specific deadline with Consumer Affairs Victoria, as privacy-handling obligations for rental applications were strengthened in the 2025–26 reforms.

Section 4 — Ongoing Tenancy Obligations

- ☐ ☐ **Give 90 days' notice for rent increases** (extended from 60 days, effective 25 November 2025).
- ☐ ☐ **Understand no-fault evictions are banned** — you must have a specific legal ground to end a tenancy, whether fixed-term or periodic.
- ☐ ☐ **Respond to repair requests promptly**, particularly anything affecting the mandatory minimum standards — unresolved requests can escalate to VCAT, where compensation or rent-reduction orders are possible.
- ☐ ☐ **Complete the exit condition report within 10 days** of a tenancy ending.
- ☐ ☐ **Lodge and manage bonds only through the RTBA** — rental providers and agents do not hold bond funds directly in Victoria.

Section 5 — Penalties for Non-Compliance

- ☐ ☐ **Know the financial exposure**. Failing to meet mandatory safety standards can result in significant fines — reported figures indicate penalties around \$12,000 for businesses and lower but still substantial amounts for individual rental providers per breach; always confirm current penalty unit values, as these are indexed and can change.
- ☐ ☐ **Understand VCAT's compensation powers** — beyond fines, VCAT can order compensation to the renter, which can include a rent reduction for every day a property was non-compliant.

☐ [] **Check your insurance policy's compliance requirements** — some landlord insurance policies can be voided by non-compliance with mandatory safety checks, compounding the financial risk of skipping them.

Quick Reference — VIC Landlord Compliance Calendar

OBLIGATION	FREQUENCY
Smoke alarm safety check	Annual
Gas safety check	Every 2 years
Electrical safety check	Every 2 years
Minimum standards compliance	Before advertising, and maintained throughout tenancy
Rent increase notice	90 days
Exit condition report	Within 10 days of tenancy ending

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